

Volume trend. Does a rising or falling volume trend over the life of the chart pattern suggest better or worse performance after the breakout? Before I answer that, we see that volume trends upward 66% of the time in the descending broadening wedge.

Rising/Falling volume. Performance of wedges is mixed depending on the breakout direction. That inconsistency bothers me. Upward breakouts show better performance if volume was trending down in the pattern. Downward breakouts show the reverse with a rising volume trend (within the pattern, from start to end of it) pushing price higher after the breakout.

Breakout day volume. Wedges with breakout day volume heavier than the prior month's average show better performance after the breakout. The result matches common trading lore.

I left off **Table 13.7** (how often stops hit) because the method to calculate stops doesn't apply to the shape of this pattern.

[Table 13.8](#) shows the average performance over three decades.

Performance over time. Upward breakouts show the best performance happened in the 2000s, and downward breakouts performed worse then. That might be because the 2000s had a whopper of a bull market run in technology stocks. Upward breakouts would be pulled along, and downward breakouts would fight a rising tide. The two bear markets in the 2000s were excluded from the numbers.

Failures over time. Upward breakouts show failures climbing from the 1990s to the 2010s. Downward breakouts suffered in the 2010s with almost half of wedges failing to see price drop more than 5% after the breakout. That's startlingly bad, and I'm a writer who doesn't like using adverbs.